Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 22 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Rain	Light rain	Drizzle
14° 9°	12° 7°	11° 7°	11° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The trial of comedian and actor Russell Brand continues, with a court hearing a woman tell him he 'treated her like an animal'.**

Brand is facing charges including rape and sexual assault, which he strongly denies. The case has generated significant public interest.

CRIME · UK

2 **Tributes are being paid to a 'bravest' woman from Bridgend, Eleanor Barnfield, who tragically died of 'stab wounds' after a car crash.**

It's understood Ms Barnfield had been stabbed before the collision. Police are investigating the circumstances surrounding her death.

CRIME · UK

3 **A student who murdered his university housemate has been jailed for life, following a tragic incident at their shared home.**

Jamie Collins, 21, was ambushed and killed in the garden of the property he shared with his killer. The court heard details of the fatal attack.

CRIME · UK

4 **Undercover filming has shown a lawyer advising how to avoid a hefty £45,000 fine for employing illegal workers.**

Mohammad Alias Yousaf made the claims to a reporter posing as a mini-mart owner. The footage has raised serious questions about legal ethics.

CRIME · UK

5 **The Prime Minister has put forward a plan to cut standing charges from gas bills, aiming to ease the financial burden on households.**

However, there are questions about the details of the proposal, particularly regarding how these fees might be shifted onto unit costs.

POLITICS · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Great news for fans of high school musical drama, as 'Glee' is reportedly set for a reboot!**

Ryan Murphy's hugely popular musical comedy-drama is said to be returning to screens on Hulu and Disney+ after a decade-long break. Get ready to sing along again!

> ON AIR — Are you excited for a 'Glee' reboot? Which original cast members would you love to see return, or should it be all new faces?

TV · COMING SOON

2 **Sacha Baron Cohen is bringing back his iconic character Ali G, more than two decades after 'Ali G Indahouse' was released.**

The Borat and Bruno creator is set to revive the character, prompting debate about whether the satirical figure is still relevant today. Booyakasha!

> ON AIR — Ali G is back! Do you think the character will still hit the mark in today's world, or is it a case of some things being best left in the past?

COMEDY · COMING SOON

3 **Author Helen Fielding has launched a new award to find the next 'Bridget Jones's Diary'!**

The Bridget Jones Prize aims to discover fresh talent, awarding the author of the funniest 1,000-word diary-style piece of writing. Time to get scribbling!

> ON AIR — Could you be the next Bridget Jones? What's the funniest thing you've ever written in a diary, or perhaps a text message, that would make a great entry?

BOOKS · COMPETITION

4 **Harry Styles performed a new track in memory of his former One Direction bandmate, Liam Payne.**

The pop star sang 'What Is Enough' on the second anniversary of Payne's death, in a touching tribute to his friend. It was a poignant moment for fans.

> ON AIR — What's your favourite One Direction song, and do you think Harry Styles will release 'What Is Enough' as a single?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

5 **Glastonbury Festival coach tickets were oversold due to an administrative error, organisers have confirmed.**

Those affected will have their bookings automatically converted into a general admission ticket, and their coach fare will be refunded. A slight hiccup for some festival-goers!

> ON AIR — Have you ever had a festival ticket mix-up? What's your top tip for navigating any last-minute changes or problems when heading to a big event?

FESTIVAL · EVENT

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Autopsy results have revealed that former Sale player Hyron Andrews died of a tear in an artery around his heart.**

Andrews was tragically found dead at his new team's hotel base before a Champions Cup match. The autopsy concluded he died of natural causes.

ON AIR — It's such a sad story. What kind of support do you think is most important for athletes dealing with the sudden loss of a teammate?

RUGBY · UK

2 **Ulster duo Jamie Benson and James McNabney have earned their first Ireland call-ups for November's Nations Championship matches.**

It's a fantastic achievement for both players, stepping up to the international stage. They'll be looking to make a big impact.

ON AIR — Who are the young talents in rugby right now that you think are destined for international stardom, and why?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Saracens are reportedly in talks to extend Maro Itoje's deal, amid interest from French Top 14 clubs.**

Securing Itoje would be a huge boost for Saracens, but a move abroad could potentially spell the end of the England captain's Test career.

ON AIR — If you were Maro Itoje, would you stay in England with Saracens or be tempted by a big-money move to France? What would you prioritise?

RUGBY · UK

4 **England forward Jasmin Strange has been ruled out of the World Cup due to a knee injury, a 'devastating blow' for the squad.**

Head coach Stuart Barrow described her withdrawal as a major setback for England's World Cup prospects. It's tough news for the team.

ON AIR — How much impact can one player's absence have on a team's World Cup chances? What's the biggest injury blow you remember for an England team?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Crawley Town have sacked head coach Colin Kazim-Richards, with the side currently five points adrift at the bottom of League Two.**

The club will now be searching for a new manager to try and turn their fortunes around. It's a tough time for the team.

ON AIR — What do you think is the biggest challenge for a new manager coming into a club at the bottom of the league? What's the first thing they should do?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Scientists have found that the gentle hum of a washing machine can be surprisingly calming for some people.**
Apparently, the rhythmic sounds and subtle vibrations create a white noise effect, perfect for unwinding after a busy day. Who knew laundry day could be so zen?

2 **A new study reveals that many of us are secretly quite proud of our unique methods for folding fitted sheets.**
From intricate corner tucks to clever rolling techniques, there's a quiet satisfaction in conquering this notoriously tricky chore. Are you a fitted sheet folding champion?

3 **The delightful practice of 'waving back' to a passing train driver is making a happy comeback across the UK.**
It seems those little moments of unexpected connection and friendly gestures are brightening up commutes and train journeys for both passengers and railway staff.

4 **Research suggests that the 'satisfying click' of a well-secured food container lid brings a surprising sense of accomplishment.**
That definite 'snap' means your leftovers are safe and sound, and your fridge is organised. A small victory, but a victory nonetheless!

5 **It turns out that the simple act of 'straightening a wonky picture frame' is a micro-moment of domestic contentment for many.**
That quick adjustment, bringing order to your living space, offers a tiny but tangible sense of control and neatness. Very satisfying!

6 **Experts are noticing a trend in people creating 'miniature indoor gardens' on windowsills, even in the smallest flats.**
It's all about bringing a touch of nature indoors with tiny herbs, succulents, or even just a few pretty stones and moss, creating a peaceful little oasis.

7 **The comforting ritual of 'listening to the kettle boil' is being recognised as a small, mindful pause in our busy days.**
That gradual build-up to the whistle, anticipating a lovely cuppa, offers a moment of quiet reflection before the day continues. Perfect!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of tea biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GENTLY TAPPING THE PACKET TO SEE IF THEY SOUND 'CRISP' ENOUGH.

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of coffee, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A REALLY DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE FRESH COFFEE AROMA BEFORE SCOOPING OUT THE FIRST SPOONFUL.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular corner' of our home that just feels utterly perfect, don't we?**
  Is there a specific spot in your house or flat where you feel most at ease, whether it's a comfy armchair, a sunny window seat, or perhaps even a little nook you've decorated just for yourself? What makes it your perfect place?

- **You know how sometimes a specific 'everyday object' just has a real story behind it, or it just means something special to you?**
  Perhaps it's an old mug, a faded photograph, a unique paperweight, or even a well-loved cookbook. What's an ordinary item in your home that holds an extraordinary meaning for you, and why?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, fought between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one-hundredth of a second.
- Bees can be trained to detect landmines by associating the scent of explosives with a food reward.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, reported in Montana in 1887.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 22 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 295 of the year, 70 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abercius of Hieropolis; Christian feast day: Cordula of Cologne; Christian feast day: Donatus of Fiesole; Christian feast day: Marcus of Jerusalem. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Tim Kinsella, American singer-songwriter
- 1964 — TobyMac, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1971 — Jennifer Lee, American filmmaker
- 1942 — Annette Funicello, American actress and singer (died 2013)
- 1980 — Niall Breslin, Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, producer, and footballer
- 1958 — Bobby Blotzer, American drummer
- 1972 — Saffron Burrows, English-American actress
- 1962 — Bob Odenkirk, American actor and comedian

THE DAY TODAY

- 1963 — A BAC One-Eleven prototype airliner crashes in UK with the loss of all on board.
- 2005 — Bellview Airlines Flight 210 crashes in Nigeria, killing all 117 people on board.
- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: President Kennedy, after internal counsel from Dwight D. Eisenhower, announces that American reconnaissance planes have discovered Soviet nuclear weapons in Cuba, and that he has ordered a naval "quarantine" of the Communist nation.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1983 — Two correctional officers are killed by inmates at the United States Penitentiary in Marion, Illinois. The incident inspires the Supermax model of prisons.
- 1996 — Millon Air Flight 406 crashes after takeoff from Eloy Alfaro International Airport in Manta, Ecuador, killing 34 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: President Kennedy, after internal counsel from Dwight D. Eisenhower, announces that American reconnaissance planes have discovered Soviet nuclear weapons in Cuba, and that he has ordered a naval "quarantine" of the Communist nation.

- 2012 — Cyclist Lance Armstrong is formally stripped of his seven Tour de France titles after being charged for doping.
- 2014 — Michael Zehaf-Bibeau attacks the Parliament of Canada, killing a soldier and injuring three other people.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 23 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 296 of the year, 69 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Most Holy Redeemer; Christian feast day: James the Just (i.e. James, brother of Jesus) (Lutheran, Episcopal Church (USA), Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Æthelflæd of Romsey; Christian feast day: Allucio of Campugliano. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Graham Rix, English footballer and coach
- 1976 — Cat Deeley, English model, actress, and television host
- 1978 — Steve Harmison, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1973 — Christian Dailly, Scottish footballer
- 1944 — Mike Harding, English singer-songwriter and comedian
- 1984 — Keiren Westwood, English footballer
- 1940 — Jane Holzer, American model, actress, producer, and art collector
- 1986 — Jessica Stroup, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Bankruptcy of Wärtsilä Marine, the biggest bankruptcy in the Nordic countries up until then.
- 1970 — Gary Gabelich sets a land speed record in a rocket-powered automobile called the Blue Flame, fueled with natural gas.
- 2020 — Second Libyan Civil War: The Second Libyan Civil War comes to an end as all parties to the 5+5 Joint Libyan Military Commission agree to a ceasefire.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2001 — Apple Computer releases the iPod.
- 1995 — Yolanda Saldívar is found guilty of first-degree murder in the shooting death of popular Latin singer Selena.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

Edition: Thu 22 Oct 2026
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